

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel | Defender for Endpoint | SOAR | Incident Response | Vulnerability Management | DLP | PAM

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Engineer with more than five years of experience conducting vulnerability assessments, implementing risk management processes, engineering Microsoft Sentinel Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) detections and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks, and responding to Tier 3 security incidents across complex enterprise environments. I have hands-on expertise in the full Microsoft security stack including Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft Defender for Cloud Apps, Microsoft Defender for Office 365, Azure Active Directory (Entra ID), Microsoft Purview, and Azure Sentinel, and I have deployed and managed these controls across an 8,000-user estate. I am experienced in identity access control, Data Loss Prevention (DLP), threat intelligence monitoring, penetration test participation, and Privileged Access Management (PAM). I am seeking a Senior Cyber Security Engineer role based on a hybrid model where I can bring my depth of Microsoft security tooling and incident response expertise to protect a leading international organisation.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Microsoft Defender Stack:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft Defender for Cloud Apps, Microsoft Defender for Office 365 - Strong; 8,000-user deployment
- **SIEM / Detection Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel / Azure Sentinel (KQL), SIEM detection engineering, correlation rule development, alert tuning, CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM
- **SOAR / Automation:** Microsoft Sentinel SOAR, Azure Logic Apps SOAR playbooks, CrowdStrike Fusion SOAR, PowerShell automation
- **Incident Response (IR):** Tier 3 security incident response, NIST 800-61, MITRE ATT&CK, threat hunting, forensic analysis, root cause analysis (RCA)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Vulnerability assessments, penetration test participation and remediation co-ordination, Tenable.io, AppCheck, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Nessus, risk management processes
- **Identity and Access:** Azure Active Directory (Entra ID), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), identity access control, BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Data Protection:** Microsoft Purview, Data Loss Prevention (DLP), sensitivity labels, information protection, Microsoft Purview Compliance Manager
- **Cloud and Endpoint Security:** Cloud security monitoring, Azure security controls, Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM, endpoint security policy management
- **Email Security:** Mimecast, phishing defence, email gateway security
- **Frameworks:** NIST CSF, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- University of the Arts London (UAL) - Senior Cyber Security Analyst/Engineer March 2025 - Present
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- Engineering 40+ custom RQL-based detection rules aligned to MITRE ATT&CK, and developing Azure Logic Apps automation playbooks to accelerate analyst response to security incidents.
 - Conduct vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), rolling out and implementing risk management processes and tracking remediation across cloud and on-premises infrastructure.
 - Implement identity access control measures and Data Loss Prevention (DLP) controls using Azure Active Directory (Entra ID) Conditional Access, Microsoft Purview, and Microsoft Defender for Cloud Apps, protecting 8,000+ users from data exfiltration and unauthorised access.

- Respond to Tier 3 security incidents as senior technical escalation point, performing host and network forensic investigation, threat containment, and root cause analysis (RCA), aligned to NIST 800-61 incident response lifecycle.
- Monitor threat intelligence feeds and apply threat intelligence to SIEM detection engineering, hunting for adversarial Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures (TTPs) using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Microsoft Sentinel.
- Participate in and co-ordinate penetration tests, managing the remediation of findings with infrastructure and application teams, and reporting risk posture to senior stakeholders.
- Manage Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI), Defender for Cloud Apps, and Defender for Office 365, maintaining enterprise-wide cloud and endpoint security posture across the 8,000-user Microsoft 365 estate.
- Administer BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) platform, enforcing least-privilege principles and managing privileged session recording and approval workflows.

University of the Arts London (UAL) – Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity
 Administered security tools and infrastructure for a Security as a Service (SaaS) cloud platform, managing endpoint protection, firewalls, VPN, patch management, and Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM. *March 2022 – March 2025*

- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI), Defender for Cloud Apps, and Defender for Office 365 across the 8,000-user M365 estate, providing cloud and endpoint security monitoring and protection.
- Implemented Azure Active Directory (Entra ID) Conditional Access policies, MFA enrolment, and SSO configuration, enforcing identity access controls and reducing identity-based attack surface.
- Implemented Data Loss Prevention (DLP) controls and sensitivity labels using Microsoft Purview, preventing the exfiltration of sensitive institutional data across cloud and email channels.
- Monitored and investigated Tier 2/3 security alerts from Microsoft Sentinel and Microsoft Defender, performing incident triage, containment, and escalation using the NIST 800-61 incident response framework.
- Conducted threat hunting exercises using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Microsoft Sentinel KQL, proactively identifying indicators of compromise (IoCs) and emerging adversarial TTPs.
- Managed Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM), enforcing device compliance policies and endpoint security baselines.
- Supported vulnerability management activities using Tenable.io and Nessus, conducting scheduled scans, analysing results, and co-ordinating remediation with system owners.

HQX Solutions Ltd (SaaS FinTech) – IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure
 Administered security tools and infrastructure for a Security as a Service (SaaS) cloud platform, managing endpoint protection, firewalls, VPN, patch management, and Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM. *February 2021 – March 2022*

- Implemented identity access control measures including Azure Active Directory, Conditional Access, MFA, and Group Policy, protecting user accounts and reducing the risk of unauthorised access.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments and security audits, coordinating remediation activities and reporting risk findings to management.
- Contributed to ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials Plus compliance activities, developing security documentation and supporting risk assessment processes.
- Used PowerShell to automate identity management, security configuration, and compliance reporting tasks across the Azure AD and Microsoft 365 environment.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI), Defender for Cloud Apps, and Defender for Office 365 across an 8,000-user estate at UAL, delivering unified cloud and endpoint security protection and significantly improving threat visibility.
- Engineered 40+ custom Microsoft Sentinel detection rules and SOAR playbooks at UAL, automating alert enrichment, containment, and notification workflows aligned to MITRE ATT&CK, reducing analyst alert triage time considerably.
- Implemented BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) at UAL, eliminating standing privileged access and enforcing just-in-time (JIT) controls, substantially reducing privileged account compromise risk.
- Implemented Microsoft Purview Data Loss Prevention (DLP) controls at UAL, enforcing sensitivity labels and preventing data exfiltration across Microsoft 365 workloads including Exchange Online, SharePoint, and Teams.

- Led vulnerability management programme at UAL using Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Pentera BAS, achieving consistent quarterly reductions in critical and high-severity vulnerabilities across cloud and on-premises infrastructure through structured risk management and remediation processes.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Salary Expectation: GBP 75,000-90,000 | Hybrid (Birmingham / UK)